Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Tuesday, 20 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Heavy drizzle	Light rain	Drizzle	Light rain
13° 11°	12° 10°	13° 11°	12° 9°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The Met Office has issued a severe weather warning for parts of the UK, with gales expected later this week.**

This could be the country's first named storm of the autumn, bringing strong winds and potentially disruptive weather. Forecasters are keeping a close eye on developments.

WEATHER · UK

2 **A new report warns of a 'postcode lottery' driving children's inequality across England, with many being failed by the system.**

The Children's Commissioner, Dame Rachel De Souza, says her landmark report highlights significant disparities depending on where a child grows up. It raises serious concerns about access to opportunities and support.

SOCIAL ISSUES · UK

3 **A trial has heard claims that activist Tommy Robinson 'intimidated' Daily Mail reporters.**

He's accused of using "bully-boy tactics" and faces charges of harassment causing fear of violence. Mr Robinson denies all the allegations.

CRIME · UK

4 **Bereaved families could face an 'unjust' tax bill due to civil service pension delays, according to a parliamentary committee.**

The chairman of Parliament's Public Accounts Committee says it's unfair for families to be penalised financially for delays that aren't their fault. It's a situation causing distress for many.

POLITICS · UK

5 **People playing loud music on buses in England could soon face a £100 fine as part of new antisocial behaviour rules.**

There's also a new campaign launching for train passengers, encouraging everyone to "share the carriage, not the noise." It's all about making public transport more pleasant for everyone.

SOCIAL ISSUES · UK

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02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Turkish girl group Manifest are preparing for their first UK concert, taking their music to a global audience.**

It's been a turbulent year for the group, going from reality TV to performing at Wembley Arena. They're definitely one to watch!

ON AIR — Have you heard of Manifest? Are you excited to see them perform in the UK?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **Apu from The Simpsons is returning with a new voice after an eight-year absence from the show.**

The much-loved Kwik-E-Mart shopkeeper has been seen but not heard around Springfield for years due to a race row. Fans will be eager to hear his new sound.

ON AIR — Are you glad to see Apu back in The Simpsons, and do you think a new voice is the right move?

TV · COMING UP

3 **The new 'Street Fighter' movie is being touted as 'made by fans for fans,' but can it win over the critics?**

The cast, including Noah Centineo and Andrew Koji, are keen to impress with the latest video game adaptation. It's a big challenge to satisfy both gamers and film buffs.

ON AIR — Are you a fan of the Street Fighter games? Do you think video game adaptations ever live up to expectations?

FILM · COMING UP

4 **Robert Pattinson stars in the new film 'Primetime,' portraying the real-life host of the American TV show 'To Catch a Predator'.**

The film explores how hunting predators became a hit TV sensation. It's a gripping role for Pattinson, delving into a controversial topic.

ON AIR — Robert Pattinson has taken on some really interesting roles. What's your favourite of his performances?

FILM · COMING UP

5 **If you're still deciding on your Halloween costume, some popular outfits are already emerging for this year.**

Freaky Nikki, Dolly Parton, and whimsical gargoyle costumes are proving popular among adults. It sounds like there will be some creative outfits out and about!

ON AIR — What's the best Halloween costume you've ever worn or seen? Are you dressing up this year?

CULTURE · THIS WEEK

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Cristiano Ronaldo has been handed a 30-day suspension and a £215 fine by the Portuguese Football Federation.**

This follows his departure from the international camp last month. It means he'll miss some crucial games for his club.

ON AIR — Do you think Ronaldo's punishment is fair, or is it too lenient/harsh for leaving the national team?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Manchester City's Erling Haaland is a doubt for Tuesday's Champions League game against AEK Athens.**

City coach Enzo Maresca is exploring his attacking options, with Semenyo also out. It's a big challenge for the team ahead of a key European fixture.

ON AIR — How big a blow is Haaland's potential absence for Manchester City? Who should step up in his place?

FOOTBALL · THIS WEEK

3 **Britain's Sonay Kartal missed out on the Wuhan Open title, losing to Maja Chwalinska in the final.**

Despite the defeat, it caps a remarkable run for Kartal in only her third event since returning from a six-month injury lay-off. She's shown incredible resilience to reach the British number one spot.

ON AIR — What an incredible comeback story for Sonay Kartal! Who are your favourite British tennis stars right now?

TENNIS · UK

4 **Former Scotland captain Jamie Ritchie is finally set to make his Glasgow Warriors debut this weekend.**

Glasgow assistant coach Nigel Carolan says the time has come to "unleash" Ritchie. Fans will be eager to see him in action for his new club.

ON AIR — How much impact do you think Jamie Ritchie will have on the Glasgow Warriors team this season?

RUGBY · UK

5 **Kylian Mbappe scored twice as Real Madrid beat Sevilla 4-1 in La Liga, closing the gap on Barcelona.**

This win puts them six points behind their rivals ahead of next weekend's El Clasico. It's setting up to be a thrilling encounter!

ON AIR — Mbappe is in incredible form! Who do you think will come out on top in next weekend's El Clasico?

FOOTBALL · THIS WEEK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **A new trend sees people creating 'miniature libraries' for their favourite biscuits.**
Instead of just having them in a tin, enthusiasts are crafting tiny shelving units and labels, giving each type of biscuit its own special home. It's a charming way to celebrate a beloved British snack.

2 **The simple act of 'darning socks' is making a surprising comeback amongst younger generations.**
Moving away from fast fashion, many are finding satisfaction in mending beloved items, turning a practical chore into a mindful hobby. It's a lovely nod to sustainability and saving those comfy old favourites.

3 **Experts suggest that the sound of a 'kettle boiling' is one of the most comforting noises in British homes.**
It's not just the promise of tea, but the familiar gurgle and whistle that evokes feelings of warmth, relaxation, and routine for many across the country. A true auditory hug!

4 **The joy of 'post-it note art' is brightening up offices and homes.**
People are using colourful sticky notes to create pixelated masterpieces on walls and windows, transforming everyday spaces into vibrant galleries. It's a low-cost, high-impact way to add a bit of cheer.

5 **A recent study found that 'matching your socks' isn't just for laundry day; it's a small act of daily self-care.**
Taking that extra moment to pair them up can contribute to a sense of order and preparedness, setting a positive tone for the day. Who knew socks could be so therapeutic?

6 **The delightful practice of 'leaving anonymous compliments' is spreading joy in communities.**
Little notes praising someone's garden, outfit, or kind deed are being left for strangers to find, creating unexpected moments of happiness and connection. It's a lovely way to brighten someone's day.

7 **There's a growing appreciation for the distinct smell of 'old books' and libraries.**
A recent survey showed that the scent, often described as a mix of vanilla and grass, evokes feelings of nostalgia and comfort. It seems we're all a bit sentimental for stories past.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to having a particular 'odd ritual' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new pack of biscuits, especially if they're a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: LINING THEM UP IN ORDER OF PREFERENCE, READY FOR SYSTEMATIC CONSUMPTION.

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when trying to quickly judge if a new brand of tea will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?**

ANSWER: SMELLING THE DRY TEA LEAVES INTENSELY, AS IF THAT WILL TRULY REVEAL ITS INNER GOODNESS.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you discover a 'hidden gem' in your local area – perhaps a lovely little café, a quiet park bench with a great view, or a fascinating independent shop that you'd never noticed before?**
  We'd love to hear about the 'hidden gems' you've stumbled upon in your own towns or villages, the places that make you smile and perhaps aren't widely known. What makes them so special?

- **We all have those little 'everyday moments of triumph' that just make life feel a bit better, don't we? Like successfully parallel parking on the first try, or managing to open a stubborn jar without any fuss.**
  What are your most recent 'everyday moments of triumph'? Those little victories that might seem small to others but felt like a huge win for you. Give us a call and share your good news!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of owls is actually called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's said that if you collect enough dew from spiderwebs before sunrise on the first day of autumn, you can polish silver to an extraordinary shine.

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06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£4.3 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£4.3 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The distinctive red letterboxes found across the UK were first introduced in 1852.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.
- The world's first public aquarium opened in Regent's Park, London, in 1853.
- The highest number on a standard dartboard is 20.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth and can be seen from space.
- Oxford University is older than the Aztec Empire, with teaching documented as early as 1096.
- The 'richest' soil on Earth is called 'chernozem', found in regions like Ukraine and Russia, and is incredibly fertile.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES TUE 20 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 293 of the year, 72 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast days: Acca of Hexham; Christian feast days: Aderald; Christian feast days: Artemius; Christian feast days: Caprasius of Agen. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1961 — Ian Rush, Welsh footballer and manager
- 1934 — Timothy West, English actor (died 2024)
- 1937 — Wanda Jackson, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1976 — Dan Fogler, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1974 — Limmy, Scottish comedian and writer
- 1941 — Anneke Wills, English actress
- 1999 — YoungBoy Never Broke Again, American rapper
- 1984 — Mitch Lucker, American singer-songwriter (died 2012)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1947 — Cold War: The House Un-American Activities Committee begins its investigation into Communist infiltration of the Hollywood film industry, resulting in a blacklist that prevents some from working in the industry for years.
- 1986 — Aeroflot Flight 6502 crashes while landing at Kuibyshev Airport (now Kuromoch International Airport) in Kuibyshev (now present-day Samara, Russia), killing 70 people.
- 1951 — The "Johnny Bright incident" occurs during a football game between the Drake Bulldogs and Oklahoma A&M Aggies.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1981 — Two police officers and a Brink's armored car guard are killed during an armed robbery carried out by members of the Black Liberation Army and Weather Underground in Nanuet, New York.
- 1991 — A massive firestorm breaks out in the hills of Oakland and Berkeley, California killing 25 people and destroying more than 3,000 homes, apartments and condominiums.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1973 — Watergate scandal: "Saturday Night Massacre": United States President Richard Nixon fires U.S. Attorney General Elliot Richardson and Deputy Attorney General William Ruckelshaus after they refuse to fire special prosecutor Archibald Cox, who is finally fired by Solicitor Gener...

- 1952 — The Governor of Kenya Evelyn Baring declares a state of emergency and begins arresting hundreds of suspected leaders of the Mau Mau Uprising.
- 1991 — A 6.8 Mw earthquake strikes the Uttarkashi region of India, killing more than 1,000 people.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES WED 21 OCT 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 294 of the year, 71 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Honduras); Christian feast day: Céline of Laon; Christian feast day: Blessed Charles of Austria (Roman Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Fintán of Taghmon. Star sign Libra, birthstone Opal.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1971 — Conor O'Shea, Irish rugby player and coach
- 1976 — Jeremy Miller, American actor and singer
- 1988 — Glen Powell, American actor
- 1944 — Mandy Rice-Davies, English model and actress (died 2014)
- 1945 — Everett McGill, American actor
- 1995 — Doja Cat, American rapper, singer and songwriter
- 1989 — Luke Murphy, English footballer
- 1976 — Josh Ritter, American singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 2003 — Images of the dwarf planet Eris are taken and subsequently used in documenting its discovery.
- 1987 — The Jaffna hospital massacre is carried out by Indian peacekeeping forces in Sri Lanka, killing 70 Tamil patients, doctors and nurses.
- 1986 — In Lebanon, pro-Iran kidnappers claim to have abducted American writer Edward Tracy (he is released in August 1991).

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2011 — Iraq War: President Barack Obama announces that the withdrawal of United States troops from Iraq will be complete by the end of the year.
- 1966 — A colliery spoil tip slips onto houses and a school in the village of Aberfan in Wales, killing 144 people, 116 of whom were schoolchildren.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

OCTOBER 2026 · PREVIEW

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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